

should try to contact the major creditors and let them know that they were having some severe financial problems. Jackson had shrugged it off saying, “We can’t pay them anyway. So what difference does it make?”

“Another thing,” Nick continued. “One of the school board members learned that a grant may be available from a foundation that specializes in situations like yours. It’s possible to acquire grant money to help with these medical bills and even for much of the care Jordan will need over the next several years. She wants to work with you and Linn to apply for it.”

Jackson was speechless for the second time that day. “I don’t know what to say.”

“You don’t need to say anything. We did what we did because we care. But now I fear that you have positioned yourself so that just paying the medical bills won’t solve the problems anymore. You and Linn need to pray about what to do. But let me encourage you to seek good counsel and not listen to the counsel of those who look for the easy way out all the time.”

Jackson was excited about going home and telling Linn the good news about the possibility of their medical bills being taken care of by the foundation. But as he drove home, a feeling of depression came over him. He realized that they would still owe on credit cards that they had used during the last few months. He began to accept the fact that they would be paying for their ignorance and lack of self-discipline, perhaps for years.

Linn wasn’t home when Jackson arrived, so he decided to review some of the bills that had been sent during the last few weeks. Most of them were still in his desk drawer unopened. He opened the envelopes and began to sort the bills by date and amount. An hour passed as he sorted bills from gas cards, department store cards, and three major credit cards. When he totaled what he had found, he was shocked. Surely this must be some kind of mistake, he told himself. We can’t possibly owe that much.